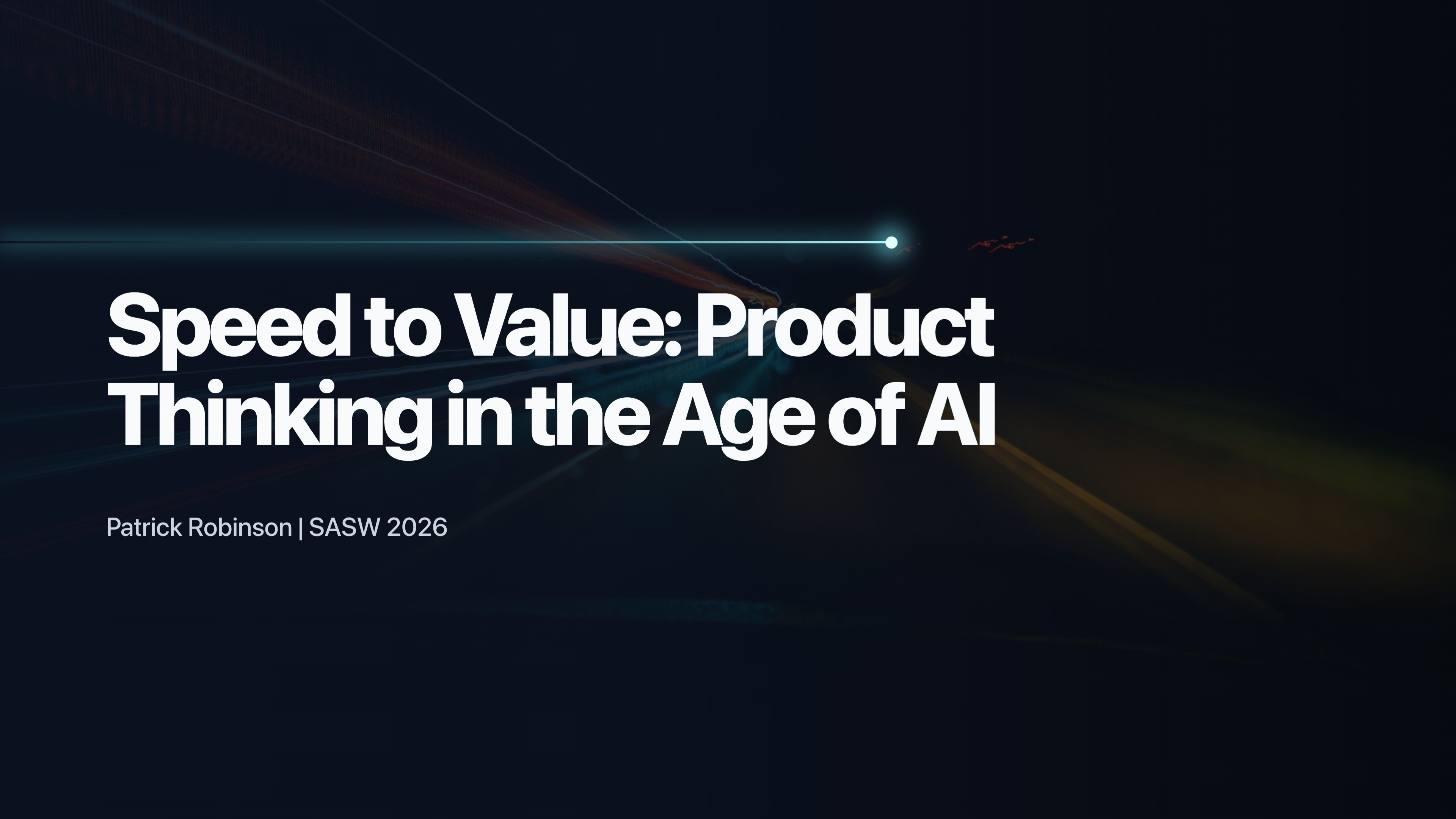


The background is a dark, deep blue gradient. It features several glowing, ethereal lines in shades of blue and white that sweep across the frame from the top left towards the center. A single, bright white point of light is positioned on a horizontal line that extends from the left edge of the image, just before the main title. The overall aesthetic is futuristic and high-tech.

Speed to Value: Product Thinking in the Age of AI

Patrick Robinson | SASW 2026



About me

Patrick Robinson

Founder, On PAR Dev

Staff Engineer, Lean TECHniques

AI Technical Coaching and Agentic Engineering

Agenda

01 The bottleneck moved

Why building got cheap and product work didn't

02 Think in systems

The skill that lets one person own the whole loop

03 Put it to work

Fast no's, fast yes's, and what to do today

Anybody Can Build an App Now

Software isn't the moat anymore

The moat: good data, deep relationships, iterating on the right problem

The hard part is building something that keeps working



The Bottleneck Moved

Before AI

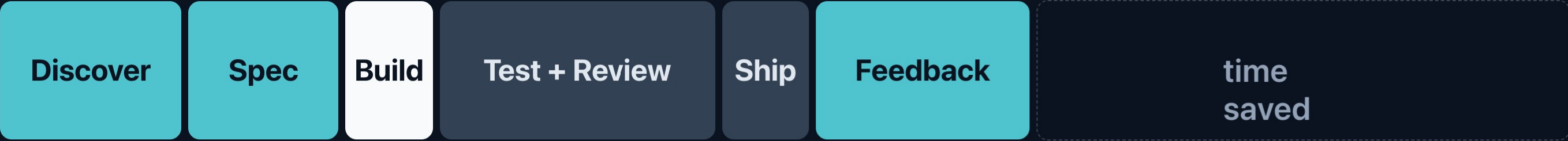


The Bottleneck Moved

Before AI



With AI

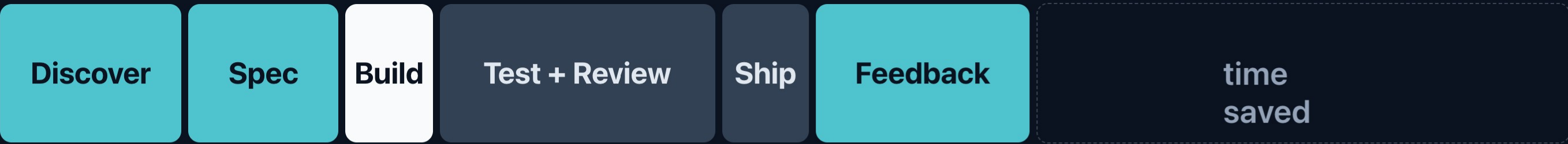


The Bottleneck Moved

Before AI



With AI



 Product work  Engineering work  Coding, ~10x faster

Skip the product work, and AI fills the gaps

Most AI slop is a workflow failure, not a model failure.

Skipped discovery

Skip the product work, and AI fills the gaps

Most AI slop is a workflow failure, not a model failure.

Skipped discovery

+

Vague spec

Skip the product work, and AI fills the gaps

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No feedback loop

Skip the product work, and AI fills the gaps

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Vague spec

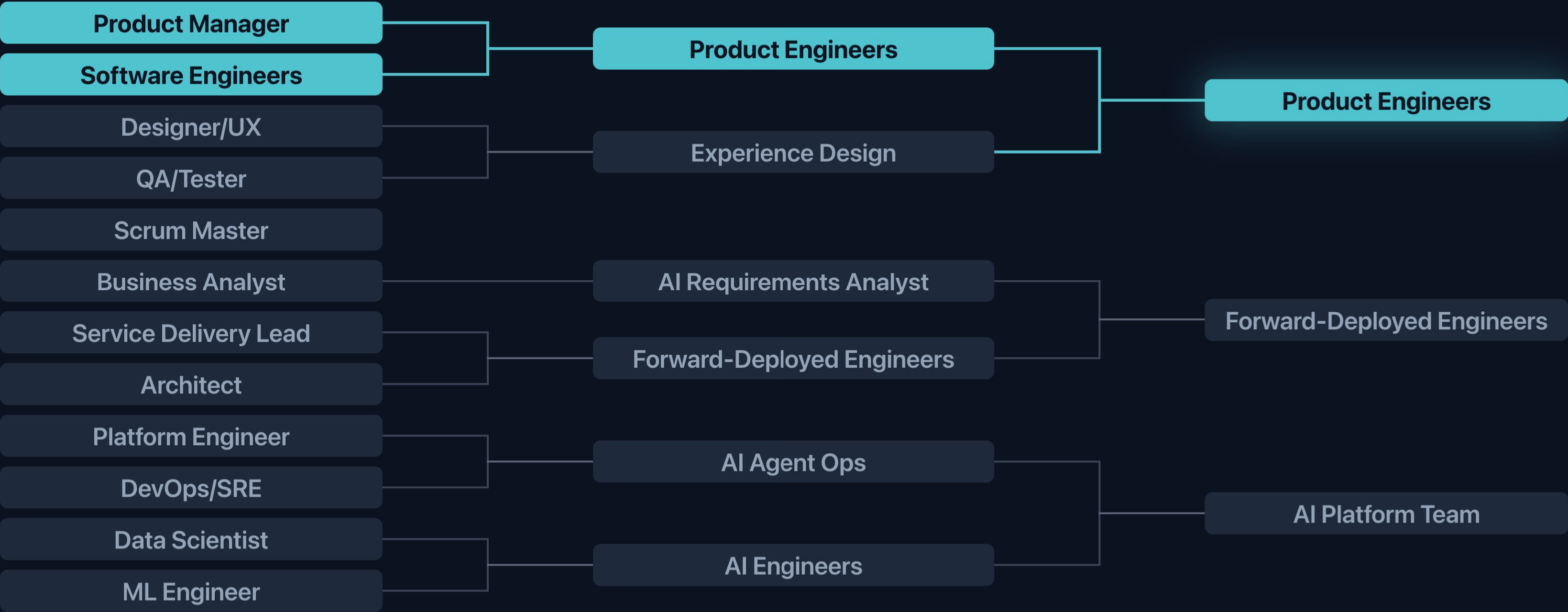
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No feedback loop

=

AI slop

Where the Roles Are Heading



The fastest path to value has no handoff.

Source: Gartner,
2026

Systems Thinking

How you apply product thinking, start to finish.



Start

Systems Thinking

How you apply product thinking, start to finish.



Systems Thinking

How you apply product thinking, start to finish.



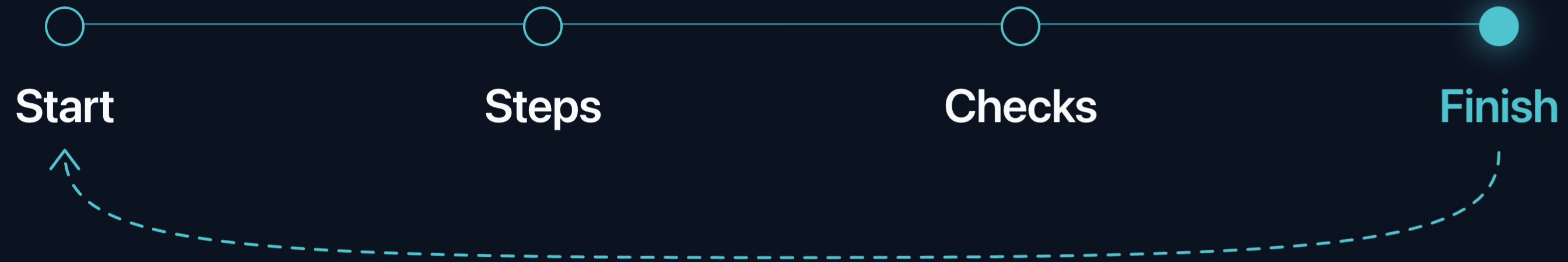
Systems Thinking

How you apply product thinking, start to finish.



Systems Thinking

How you apply product thinking, start to finish.



Checks

**If you can't check it,
you can't trust it.**

Define done before you prompt.

Make the AI prove it: tests that pass.

The real check is a real customer.

Client workflow

4 to 6
hours

30 to 60
min

Per document stack. Several can run at once.

You Already Do This



The software developer



The parent with kids

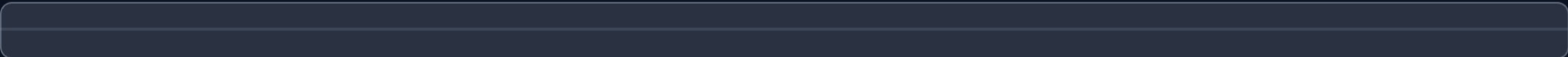


The founder at the whiteboard

You already think in systems. Now apply it to the product.

Speed to No Is Speed to Yes

One big bet



X

No, week 10

Week 0

Week 12

Speed to No Is Speed to Yes

One big bet



Tracer bullets



Week 0

Week 12

Speed to No Is Speed to Yes

One big bet



Tracer bullets



Week 0

Week 12

Every fast no buys time for the yes.

The fast no

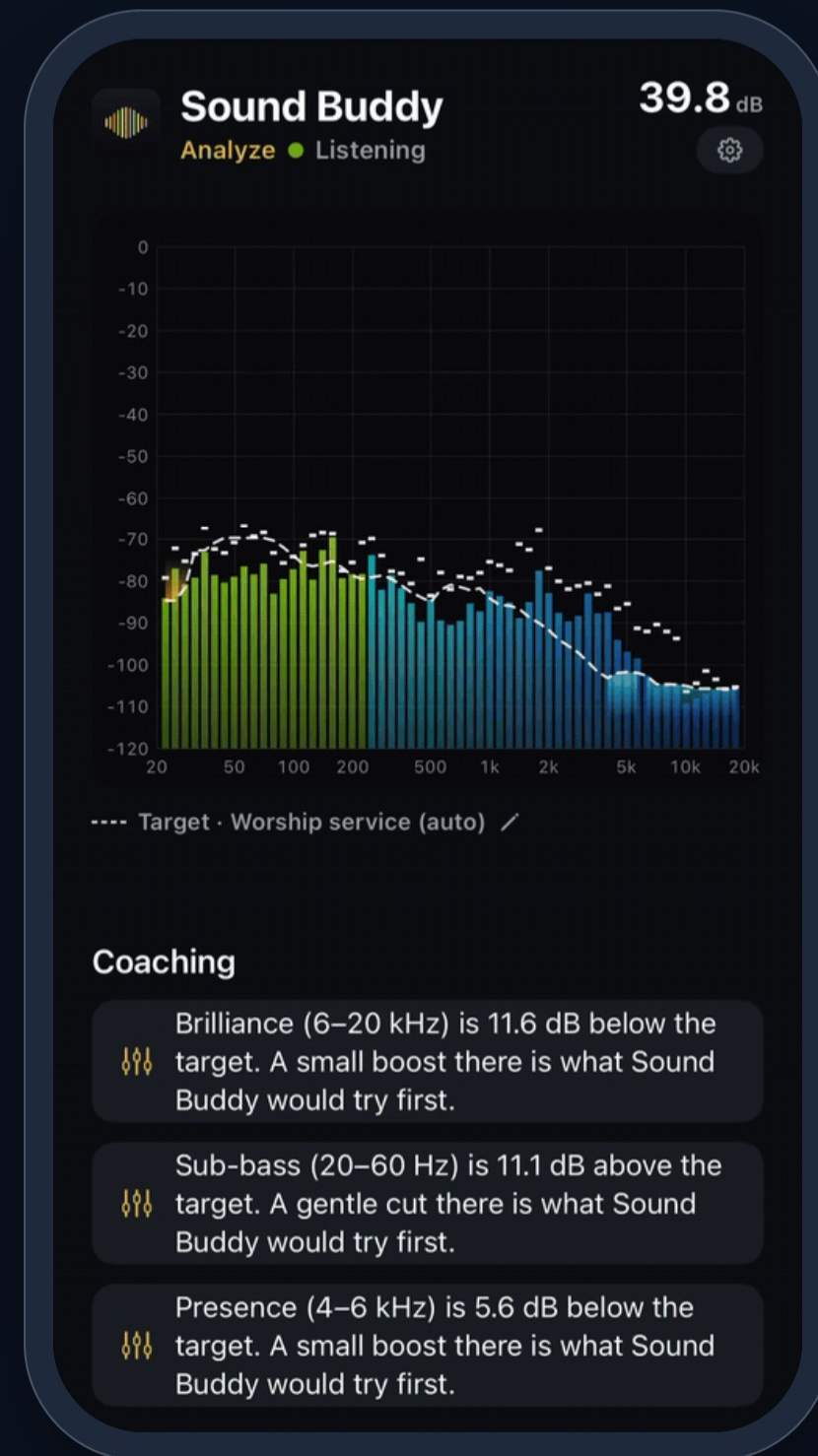
Diaper Duty: A Parenting Simulator



Time to a no: about 5 seconds.

The fast yes

SoundBuddy: one job, one morning



Listens through the phone's mic

Compares the mix to an ideal curve

Tells you what to turn up or down

**One big yes is worth
many fast no's.**

What to Do Today

If you're a founder

Pressure-test the idea with AI before building

Write down what done looks like

Put one tracer bullet in front of a customer

If you're an engineer

Sit in on customer calls

Own the outcome, not the ticket

Write the spec before the prompt

If you're in product

Build your own prototype

Learn to read the tests

Ship one tracer bullet yourself

Building is cheap. Product thinking isn't.

- 01 Product and engineering are becoming one job.
- 02 Apply systems thinking to the product, not just the code.
- 03 A fast no buys a bigger yes.

Thank You

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